

MODULE 3: BASIC TOOLS & EQUIPMENT

3.1. SURVIVAL / FIELD KNIFE

The knife is presented as the most important single survival tool, used for wood processing, shelter building, fire preparation, and game processing.

Feature	Preferred specification	Reason given in the manual
Construction	Full tang	The blade tang runs through the handle, improving strength during heavy wood processing.
Steel	Carbon (e.g. 1095) or stainless	Carbon steel is easier to sharpen in the field; stainless requires less maintenance.
Grind	Scandinavian (Scandi) or flat	Scandi is effective for wood carving and straightforward to sharpen.
Thickness / blade length	3.5-5 mm / 10-15 cm	Balance between structural strength and precision.
Spine	Sharp 90° edge	Useful for scraping a ferrocerium rod without dulling the cutting edge.

3.2. ROPE / CORDAGE

The manual describes Paracord 550 as a parachute cord rated to about 550 lb (approximately 249 kg) of static strength, with an outer sheath and seven inner cores.

Basic survival knots

- **Clove hitch:** quick attachment to a pole or tree; useful in shelter construction.
- **Bowline:** creates a fixed loop that does not tighten under load.
- **Prusik knot:** a friction hitch used for adjustable attachment and tarp tensioning.
- **Square / reef knot:** used to join two cords of similar thickness.

3.3. FIRE STARTERS

Reliable fire sources are treated as essential, with redundancy recommended.

- **Ferrocerium rod:** produces very hot sparks when scraped with a hard 90° edge and can work when wet.
- **Piezo / jet lighter:** fast and convenient but dependent on fuel and mechanical reliability.
- **Char cloth:** pyrolyzed cotton that readily catches a weak spark.

3.4. IMPROVISED TOOLS

When manufactured equipment is unavailable, the manual recommends adapting natural materials and discarded objects.

- **Baton:** a thick fresh branch used as a striking tool when splitting wood with a knife.
- **Flint and quartzite:** hard stones that can be used with suitable steel to create sparks.
- **Can / bark container:** improvised containers may be used for camp tasks; the manual specifically discusses a beverage can as a cooking vessel after removing its internal coating.